PORTFOLIA · EXAMPLE FLIPBOOK · NO. 01

Field Notes

A short guide to showing your work,
and the reading room that makes it feel printed.



Turn the page

Case study: The Hollow House

Look closer

Know when it lands

Notes in the margin

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ABOUT THIS BOOK

Everything here began as an ordinary PDF. The tabs, notes, links, video and spotlights were added afterwards in Portfolia's editor, on top of the pages, and none of them changed the file itself. Turn the pages to see each one at work.

A LETTER FROM THE READING ROOM

Your work, the way you meant it to be seen

Most portfolios are first seen as a file name in somebody else's inbox. It arrives between a meeting invite and a newsletter, is opened in a preview window that crops the edges and greys the colours, and is scrolled through at the speed of a thumb. Months of drawing, shooting, writing and rebuilding are compressed into a few seconds of vertical blur. We think that is the wrong first impression, and that it is fixable.

A printed book slows people down in a way a scrolling document never does. You hold it, you open it, you turn a page and wait for it to land. Spreads are read as pairs, so a drawing can face the paragraph that explains it. Margins hold notes. The physical rhythm tells the reader that someone has made choices about order and pace, and they respond by paying attention.

Portfolia gives your PDF that rhythm on a screen. The pages sit in a lit, three-dimensional book with real paper, a spine and a cover. Light falls across the spread from a photographed room, and each sheet bends as it turns. Nothing about your layout is redrawn or simplified: every page is your page, at the resolution you exported.

Around that book are the small tools that make a portfolio easier to read: tabs that jump to a chapter, notes that unfold on the paper, links to the rest of your work, video that plays inside the page, and spotlights that open the finest detail large and sharp. You add them in the editor, on the page you are looking at, and you can take them away again without touching the PDF.

Then there is the part that happens after you share it. A single link works on any phone or laptop and can be printed as a QR code. You can see when your portfolio is visited, and, if you like, get an email when it is opened, so you know when to follow up rather than wondering.

This book is our example. Read it like a magazine, try the features as you meet them, and then imagine your own work in its place.

— The Portfolia team

TRY THESE AS YOU READ

- Turn a page: arrows, drag or swipe
- Open a spotlight on page 6
- Peel back the note on page 7
- Jump with the tabs on the edge
- Watch the clip on page 10
- Open a link on page 11

THE BOOK

Turn the page

Light, paper and the weight of a real book.

Press an arrow, drag a corner, or swipe on a phone, and the sheet lifts from the paper beneath it. It curves as it travels, catches the light at the top of its arc, and settles on the other side with a soft shadow. The gutter darkens where the pages meet the spine, the way it does in a book on your desk.

Two appearances are built in. Simple keeps your pages exactly as exported, flat and colour-true, with only the gentlest shading at the spine. Studio places the book in a photographed room: paper picks up the colour of the light, a little texture shows in the grain, and the cover can be soft or a hardback board with cloth on its spine.

You choose how the sheet behaves. Classic is a natural bend; Firm is a stiffer sheet; Deep curl rolls through the middle; Corner lift leads from the bottom corner; Soft fold rolls the page over close to the paper, like a magazine, and its edge bows rather than running straight. A ribbon can mark a page, and the book's thickness shifts from one side to the other as it is read.

Readers who prefer to scroll can switch to Scroll or Page by page, and readers who ask their device for less motion get pages that change without animation. Whatever they choose, the pages are the same, and so are the links, notes and spotlights on them.

FIVE WAYS A PAGE CAN TURN





IN THIS PICTURE

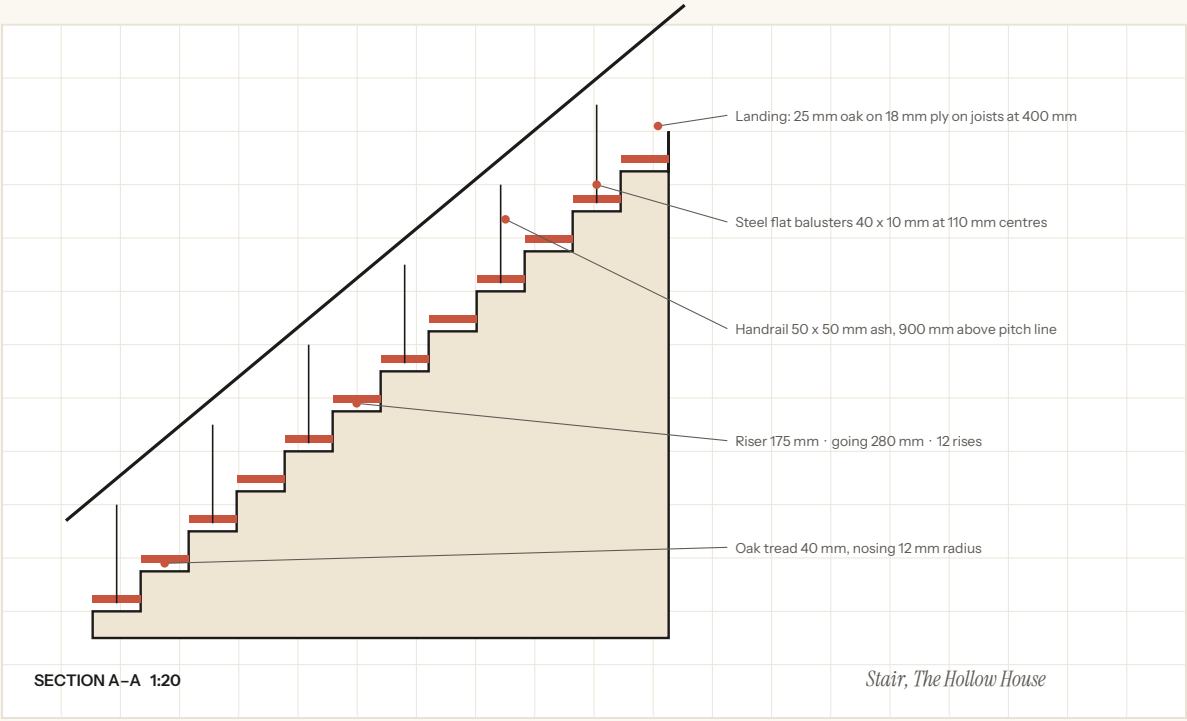
Studio light comes from real photographs of rooms, so a spread lit by a north window looks cool and even, and one lit at golden hour turns warm. The book moves through the light as it turns, and each sheet is shaded as it bends.

TRY IT NOW

Press an arrow key
or drag the page corner
Swipe on a phone
Pinch or scroll to zoom
Switch Simple and Studio

SPOTLIGHTS

Look closer



Stair, The Hollow House

Some work only makes sense up close: the line weight of a construction drawing, the weave of a fabric, the brushwork in an illustration, the grain of a print. On a phone screen that detail is the first thing to disappear.

A spotlight fixes that. Draw a box over the part of the page that matters and give it a caption. Readers see a small magnifier on the page; one tap opens that area large, drawn sharp from your PDF at the size of their screen, with your words beneath it.

Try the one on the drawing above, where the annotations are far too small to read at this size. Use the arrow keys to move between spotlights in the book, and Escape to close.

ADD A SPOTLIGHT

1. In the editor, open Customise, then Notes, tabs, links & spotlights.
2. Press Add a spotlight. A box appears on the page in view.
3. Drag it over the detail and pull its corner to fit.
4. Write a caption, or leave it to speak for itself.

Free includes 3 spotlights; Personal, 24.

NOTES

Notes in the margin

Good portfolios answer questions before they are asked. Who was the client? What did you do, and what did the team do? What was the brief, and where did you break it? That context rarely fits on the page without crowding the work.

Notes give it somewhere to live. A sticky note sits on the paper at a slight angle, like one left by a colleague. A fold-out looks like a folded card; readers open it to find a second surface inside, with more words, a picture or a sketch. Both turn with the page they are stuck to.

You place them where you are looking: add one from the editor, drag it into position, pull a corner to resize it and the round handle to turn it. The words, paper colour and typeface are yours to choose.

Use them sparingly. One note on a spread draws the eye; five turn the page into a noticeboard. A good rule is a note only where a reviewer would otherwise have to guess.



Moodboard, week two

STICKY OR FOLD-OUT?

Sticky note
One thought, seen at a glance: a role, a date, a client.

Fold-out
A second layer readers choose to open: process, a sketch, the longer story.

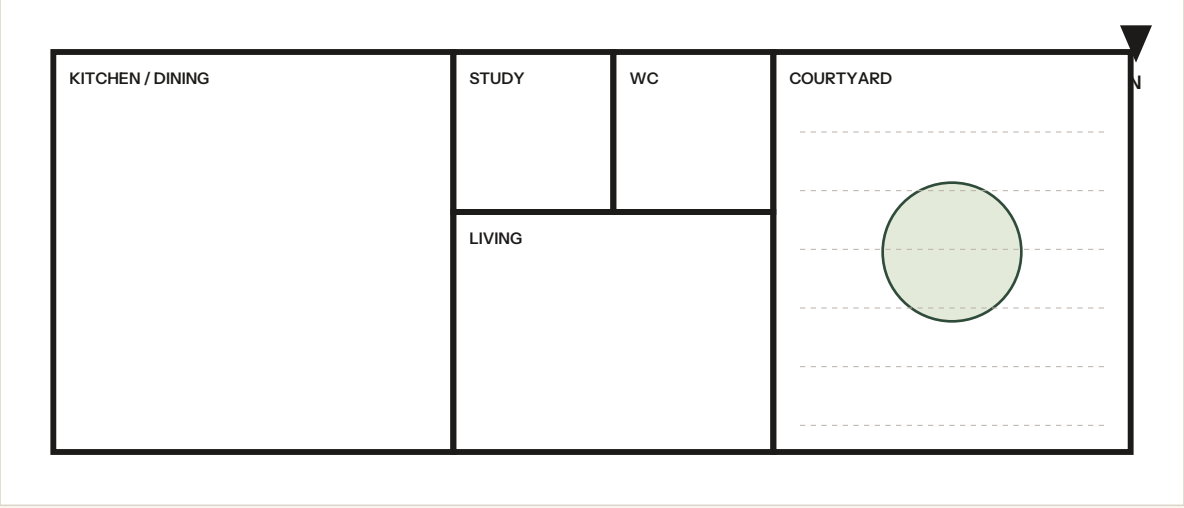
PALETTE

#2F4B3A	#8FA77F	#E3A64B	#C8553D	#EFE5D3

CASE STUDY

The Hollow House

A family home cut into a slope, told in one spread.



Ground floor plan 1:100

CLIENT	Private
LOCATION	Peak District, UK
AREA	214 sq m
ROLE	Project architect, stages 2–5
TEAM	Four, with structural and landscape consultants
STATUS	Completed 2025



The house at dusk, from the lower field.

The brief asked for a house that would disappear from the lane and open completely to the valley. We cut the ground floor into the slope, so a visitor arriving from above sees only a low roof planted with meadow grass, and the living rooms face south across a courtyard sheltered from the wind.

The plan is organised around that courtyard. Kitchen and dining wrap its western edge to catch the evening sun; the living room and study sit on the north side behind a deep oak reveal that keeps out high summer light. A single stair, detailed overleaf, rises through a slot in the roof.

Materials were chosen to weather together: local gritstone for the retaining walls, untreated larch for the cladding, and lime render inside. The building is heated by a ground-source pump and its airtightness tested at 0.9 air changes per hour.

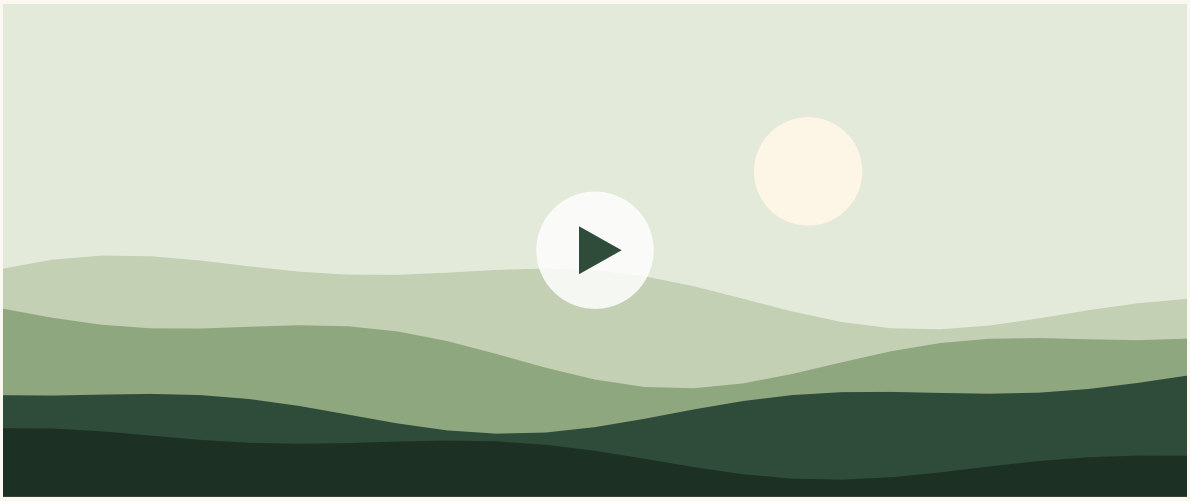
My role ran from concept design through to the end of construction: leading the planning application, coordinating the consultants and producing the detailed drawings, including the stair and the rooflight.

Two years on, the meadow roof has seeded itself from the surrounding field and the larch has silvered evenly. The family describe the courtyard as the room they use most, in every season, which was the whole point.

> *“From the lane it is a field; from the valley, a house.”*
>
> PLANNING OFFICER'S REPORT

VIDEO & GIF

Moving pictures



Turntable study, 12 seconds

Some projects move: a product turning on a stand, a garment in motion, an animation, a walkthrough of a model. A still frame can only suggest that.

On Personal, a video can be printed into the page. It plays inside the paper as if it were part of the print, starts muted, and plays only while it is on screen, so phones stay smooth. Readers tap it for sound.

An animated GIF works too. Portfolia turns it into a small looping video on your device as you add it, so it plays smoothly and loads quickly, and it never shows a sound button because it has no sound.

Keep clips short and let them loop: eight to fifteen seconds is plenty to show movement without asking for a reader's time.

CLIPS THAT WORK WELL

Turntable
a product, model or sculpture turning once

In motion
a garment, a dancer, fabric catching the light

Walkthrough
a few seconds moving through a model or an app

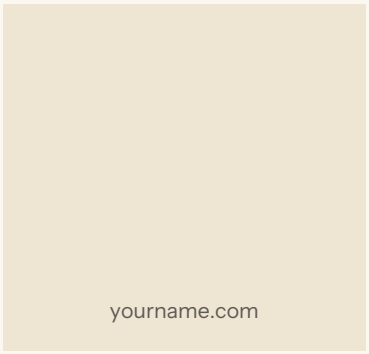
LINKS

Links that open

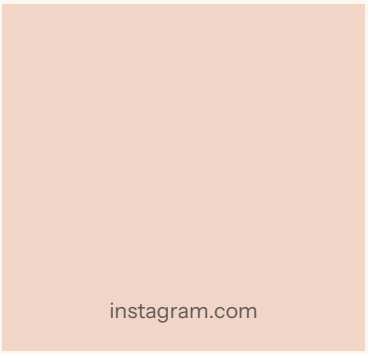
A portfolio is a selection, and good reviewers want to see what you left out. Point them to it. A website link puts the site's own logo on the page, with a caption if you like; readers click or tap it to open the site in a new tab, in every reading style.

Links in your PDF keep working too. If you exported your file with web links in it, Portfolia finds them and makes them clickable on the page, exactly where you placed them in your layout.

FIND MORE OF THE WORK



Portfolio site



Instagram



Behance

GOOD PLACES TO POINT

The full project	where the case study continues, with every drawing.
Process	a sketchbook, a research blog, a making-of video.
Proof	press, an award, a shop where the work is sold.

Read more about Portfolia at portfolia.site

That line is a link inside the PDF itself; Portfolia keeps it clickable.

PAGE TABS

Chapters at your fingertips

Coloured tabs stand out from the edge of the book, even when it is closed. Each one turns the pages to its chapter, so a reviewer can go straight to the project they care about. Look at the edge of this book: the tabs there were added in the editor in a few seconds.

FIVE RULES FOR ORDER

1. **Lead with your strongest project.**
   Reviewers decide early. Put the work you most want to be hired for first, not the work you did first.

2. **Close with your second strongest.**
   The last thing someone sees is what they remember when they put the book down.

3. **Group by project, not by medium.**
   Show sketches, models and finished pieces together, so the thinking reads as one story.

4. **Give every project one sentence.**
   What it was, what you did, what changed. Anything longer belongs in a note.

5. **Cut one more page.**
   When you think the portfolio is finished, remove the weakest page. It always gets better.

Order is the first thing a reviewer notices, and the last thing they credit you for.

SHARING

Share it anywhere

Every published portfolio has one permanent link that opens on any phone, tablet or laptop, with nothing to install. Personal adds a short address of your own, like portfolia.site/yourname.

Print the QR code on a CV, a business card or the back of a physical portfolio, and the book opens full screen on the phone that scans it.

To put the book on your own website, copy the embed code; the compact reader fits a page of any width. You can share straight to LinkedIn, X, Facebook, WhatsApp, Pinterest or email, and the post shows a preview card of your cover.

Need privacy? Add a password or an expiry date, and keep search engines away unless you ask for them.



Scan to visit portfolia.site

SHARE TO

LinkedIn · X · Facebook · WhatsApp · Pinterest · Email

EMBED CODE

```
<iframe src="https://
portfolia.site/embed/abc12"
width="100%" height="600"
allowfullscreen></iframe>
```

STATISTICS

Know when it lands



Sending a portfolio used to mean waiting in silence. Statistics show how many times your portfolio was visited, an estimate of how many different people that was, and how often the PDF was downloaded, day by day.

On Personal you can also ask for an email when someone opens it. It tells you when, on what kind of device and in which country, and nothing more: we never record a visitor's address. You get at most one every six hours, and any opens in between are counted into the next.

That is enough to know when to follow up. If a studio opens your portfolio three times in an afternoon, that is a good day to write.

128	61	9
VISITS	DIFFERENT VISITORS	DOWNLOADS

ESSAY

How reviewers read

What happens in the ninety seconds after you press send.

Ask anyone who hires designers, architects or photographers how they read a portfolio and the answers are remarkably consistent. They look at the first page for a few seconds and decide whether to keep going. They skim for the project closest to the job they are filling. They look for one moment of real depth, a detail, a process page, a decision explained, and they look for evidence that you know which of your work is best.

None of that rewards volume. A twelve-page portfolio with three projects told well beats forty pages of everything you have done, because it shows judgement, and judgement is most of what is being hired.

It also rewards making the reader's job easy. Chapters they can jump to, captions that say what your role was, and a detail they can actually see on a small screen all remove friction at exactly the moment someone is deciding whether to spend another minute with you.

Finally, it rewards timing. Portfolios are often read in batches, late, between other things. Knowing that yours has been opened lets you follow up while it is still fresh in someone's mind, rather than a week later when it is one of sixty.

There is a quieter point too. A reviewer who enjoyed reading your portfolio remembers you more kindly than one who fought with it. Pages that load quickly, turn smoothly and stay sharp when zoomed are not decoration; they are part of how your work is judged.

So choose fewer projects, put the best one first, explain your part in a sentence, make the detail visible, and send a link that opens beautifully on whatever is in their hand. The rest is the work itself.

> *"Fewer projects, told well, beat everything you have ever made."*

Make yours.

Upload the PDF you already have. Preview it as a lit book in seconds, without signing up, then publish one link that works everywhere.

WHAT'S INSIDE EVERY PORTFOLIA BOOK

- Lit 3D pages
- Notes & fold-outs
- Website links
- Spotlights
- Visit statistics
- Simple & Studio looks
- Page tabs
- Video & GIF
- QR codes & embeds
- Open emails

portfolia.site

Field Notes is an example flipbook made by Portfolia. Projects, people and figures in it are illustrative.
Set in Instrument Serif and Instrument Sans.